features in it that were pure pork. The legislators had the opportunity to override my decision—but none of my 943 vetoes in Sacramento were overturned, because legislators didn't want to publicly defend, under the full scrutiny of voters, their pork-barrel projects or items they had husbanded through their committees because of the influence of campaign donors and special-interest groups.

Until presidents have a line-item veto and there is a constitutional amendment mandating a balanced budget, I think the country is likely to face never-ending deficits piled up by a profligate Congress unable or unwilling to make the hard-nosed decisions necessary to bring down spending to a level the country can afford.

Although I was disappointed that I wasn't able to do more, we still made progress in slowing the growth of government. Despite resistance from Congress and the bureaucracy, and despite continuing population growth, the size of the federal civilian work force declined about five percent during the eight years we were in Washington. Manpower levels in some bureaucracies were cut in half, and while we were cutting the overall federal work force, minority employment went up—it rose twenty-seven percent—and the number of women in professional positions in the federal force went up thirty-four percent.

A lot of the reductions resulted from simply giving government workers the opportunity and tools to operate as efficiently as their counterparts in the private business world. In 1982, I asked J. Peter Grace, chief executive of W. R. Grace & Company and a Democrat, to establish a panel of top businessmen to study federal operations and recommend how we could reduce waste and make the government more efficient. The Grace Commission—also known as the Private Sector Survey on Cost Control—was patterned after that panel of businessmen I'd appointed when I was governor to streamline the government of